BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #44 · DISABILITY AND IMPAIRMENT

# "I'm always in the way."

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## Where it often comes from

Wheelchairs, walkers, slow movement, and special needs can make us feel obstructive in crowded places, in families, and in plans. Sighs, glances, and inaccessible spaces reinforce this.

## What Scripture teaches

Jesus welcomed the disabled and the marginalized. He said to invite "the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind," and Scripture shows people making room for them. "God settles the lonely in families." "Each member belongs to one another." Inaccessible spaces are failures of the community, not of you. God's people are called to make room. You belong, and you can say what you need.

> *"But when you host a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind"* (Luke 14:13).

## Also see

> "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land" (Psalm 68:6).

> "So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another" (Romans 12:5).

> "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

## Common self-statements

- I am a nuisance.
- Everything has to change for me.
- I slow everyone down.
- I should stay home.
- People wish I were not here.
- I take up too much space.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either fit in perfectly or I am in the way.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be an obstacle.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling awkward and concluding that I am unwelcome.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a nuisance.

## Challenging questions

- Who welcomes me without fuss?
- What places or groups are accessible and kind?
- What do I need in order to participate, and can I ask for it?
- What does Scripture say about those with disabilities?

- How do I feel when someone else asks for help?
- What gifts do I bring to a gathering?

## Truth summary

> I belong. God places the lonely in families, and Jesus welcomes everyone. I can ask for what I need, choose welcoming places, and offer my gifts.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

# My Plan for Replacing "I'm always in the way"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I'm always in the way." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ Who welcomes me without fuss?
- ☐ What places or groups are accessible and kind?
- ☐ What do I need in order to participate, and can I ask for it?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about those with disabilities?
- ☐ How do I feel when someone else asks for help?
- ☐ What gifts do I bring to a gathering?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ Jesus welcomes all.
- ☐ I belong to the body.
- ☐ I can ask for what I need.
- ☐ Barriers are not my fault.
- ☐ I have gifts to bring.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Luke 14:13
  *"But when you host a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind."*
- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  *"God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."*
- ☐ Romans 12:5
  *"So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another."*

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ I belong: Each week, note one place or person where you felt welcome.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Luke 14:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God settles the lonely in families, and I belong.""*
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- ☐ List welcoming places. Write where you feel at ease.
- ☐ Ask for accommodations. Make a clear request.
- ☐ Share a gift. Offer something to a group.
- ☐ Read Luke 14:13. Notice who Jesus invites.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm always in the way": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | I belong |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm always in the way.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I feel in the way. Thank You that You welcome everyone. Lead me to people who make room and use my gifts among them. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*